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(AMUTA) demanded a judicial probe into the Siras episode, with the chief judicial magistrate ordering that an FIR be lodged. Abrar, one of the officials named in the FIR, however, maintains that the teachers have to be role models. Sheikh Mastan, chairman of Modern Indian Languages, points out that though the letter revoking Siras' suspension was issued on April 5 it reached the department on April 8, a day after Siras was found dead.

According to Tariq Islam, who teaches philosophy, over the years AMU has turned into an island that lives in the dark ages. It used to produce historians, sportspersons, scientists, writers, artistes and film personalities but now people talk only about goons and guns. And the Siras case preceded by the v-c's decision to have 57 CCTVs installed on campus indicates that a 'madrasa mentality' is being imposed. Former AMUTA president Naeem Ahmad Khan says under the illiberal environment on campus, everyone seems to have stopped thinking about academic excellence. He says in the past AMU used to groom leaders but since the campus became a kind of barracks everyone lives in a state of fear.

But the v-c doesn't agree. All these ugly developments struck the campus



**PROFESSOR SIRAS IN FRONT OF AMU (TOP); CCTV CAMERAS CREATE AN ATMOSPHERE OF FEAR**

when Azis was vigorously trying to get his agenda for 'academic rejuvenation' implemented. He invited the teaching and research community to recapture the spirit of inquiry that was once the hallmark of AMU, hoping that the university would unlock its academic potential with fresh optimism, discipline and diligence. The attainable goals included the submission of at least 500 Ph.D theses by the end of each year, the submission of research projects by at least 500 teachers to various national

and international funding agencies with a target of Rs 200 crore for conducting new research in areas of national and regional importance, and the publication of at least one research paper annually by every teacher in the university in a peer-reviewed journal of international repute. Eager to change the face of AMU and the perception of the world about the university, Azis signed mous with several leading universities, among them John Hopkins and New York universities.



## What's

### POINT

Ever since P.K. Abdul Aziz joined as V-C, he has turned the AMU campus into a 'police state'.

Azis is the first V-C to face corruption charges and the first against whom the President has ordered an inquiry.

Why is the administration not investing in improving the infrastructure of the campus?

Is the plan to have an outside campus a conspiracy to destroy AMU?

